GENE J. RAY
Director of Product Development & Manufacturing Operations
Westborough, MA | 774-312-9273 | genejray7@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/generay

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Garden Remedies Inc. | **VP, Strategy & Program Management** | Fitchburg, MA | Sep 2024 – Nov 2025

- **Directed** cross-departmental product development strategy for a **6-brand consumer portfolio (50+ SKUs)**, driving revenue growth across ~50 launch cycles, introducing a patent-pending consumer oral pouch.
- **Accelerated** concept-to-shelf **time-to-market by 75%** (120 to 30 days) by designing enterprise stage-gate governance and cross-functional operational alignment.
- **Spearheaded AI-native workflow integration** (Claude Code/agentic automation), cutting reporting effort by 50% and execution times by 92%.
- **Formulated** Board-ready investment cases using **competitive product analyses** to shape portfolio architecture and strategic roadmaps.
- **Engineered** 15+ automated KPI dashboards (Domo/Tableau) to establish instant executive **portfolio visibility** and eliminate manual status updates.

Garden Remedies Inc. | **VP, Laboratory & Product Operations** | Fitchburg, MA | Jun 2019 – Aug 2024

- **Secured** approval for a **$1.5M facility expansion** ($700K+ CAPEX), boosting daily manufacturing capacity 6x through ROI-backed business cases.
- **Directed** a 14-person **matrixed product team** across R&D and operations, scaling extract products to **60% of total company revenue**.
- **Developed** strict **product specifications** and **functional performance testing** protocols to guarantee cross-functional commercial compliance.
- **Optimized** global **contract manufacturing and supply chains** via APAC vendor partnerships, **slashing COGS by 30%** and turnaround times by 50%.
- **Architected** a packaging-integrated **"Voice-of-Customer" loop** to capture real-time consumer data and iterate product design post-launch.

Garden Remedies Inc. | **Lab Manager / Assoc Formulation Scientist** | Fitchburg, MA | Sep 2016 – May 2019

- **Expanded** product portfolio by **45%** by aligning **R&D formulation pipelines** with target **consumer needs** and commercial retail demand.
- **Established** the company's first analytical lab, ensuring **100% of batches met strict quality and functional performance testing specifications**.
- **Authored** 100+ SOPs and **product quality specifications** to construct scalable, highly reproducible, and audit-ready operational infrastructure.
- **Facilitated** cross-functional handoffs between R&D, QC, and marketing to transition custom vapes to full-scale commercial production.

ADDITIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant | **Principal Consultant (Life Sciences & CPG)** | Remote | Dec 2025 – Present

- **Engineered** custom **Human-in-the-Loop agentic workflows** for CPG/health clients, compressing execution times by 92% and raising throughput.
- **Guides** 5 CPG clients on portfolio strategy and commercialization, utilizing **competitive product analyses** to identify white space opportunities.

Kaplan International | **Head of Science Department / Instructor** | Qingdao, China | Sep 2014 – Aug 2016

- **Led** instructor team in APAC; built operational frameworks and cross-cultural partnerships that underpin current global supply chains.

EDUCATION

- **University of Miami** | **PhD, Biochemistry & Molecular Biology** | Expected May 2027
- **Mahidol University** | **Master of Science in Pharmaceutical Chemistry** | Bangkok, Thailand
- **Fisk University** | **Bachelor of Science in Biology** | Nashville, TN

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Technical Skills:** Continuous Improvement, GMP & Audit Readiness, Functional Performance Testing, Product Lifecycle Management (PLM), Tableau, Domo, Advanced Excel, Monday.com, Asana, Smartsheet, Figma
- **AI & Automation:** LLM / Agentic AI Automation (Anthropic Claude, custom multi-step HITL workflows, Claude Code, MCP integration, Lovable apps)